

Rule 1.) If you have only ONE answer choice that can combine two independent clauses, then you should find the independent clauses.

Independent clauses must always be separated with either a **period**, a **semicolon**, a **colon**, or a **comma + coordinating conjunction**.

. ; : , and

Ex. Simple

I wanted to go for a _____ it started raining.

- A. walk,
- B. walk
- C. walk, but
- D. walk but

Ex. Complex

What the strange object that had fallen from space could be had been unknown to anyone who had seen _____ conjecturing about what it was was, nonetheless, partaken of by all.

- A. it
- B. it;
- C. it yet
- D. it,

Ex. Complex

Early that evening, his mother, who had been having a rather dreadful morning – on a quite cold and dreary day in early spring – decided, of her own accord, to bake a pie filled to the brim with blueberries for her son, who had become increasingly surly in his _____ even though she made it with love, her son, begrudgingly, had, in a moment of youthful naivety, decided – against his father’s careful recommendation – to loudly and boldly complain that he did not like blueberries, inviting a fury like no other to be brought upon himself.

- A. adolescence
- B. adolescence but
- C. adolescence,
- D. adolescence, but